

Flightless birds

Some birds cannot fly even though they have wings. Often, as a result of this, they become excellent at running or swimming instead.

New Zealand birds

There are so few mammals here that some birds have no need to fly.



Kakapo: this flightless bird is the world's rarest parrot.



Kiwi: the kiwi lives on the ground. Its feathers are so small they look like fur.



Takahe: these birds were almost extinct, but are slowly increasing in numbers.

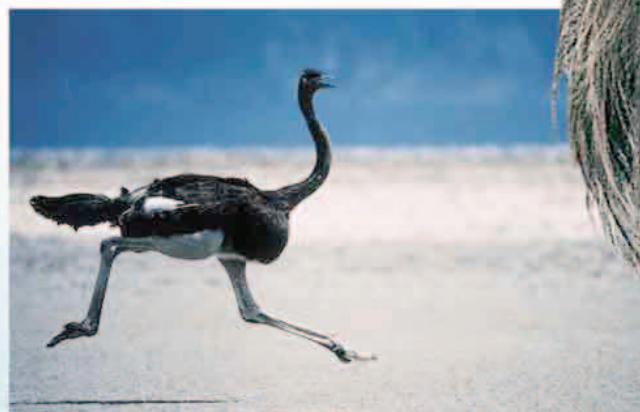
The ostrich has a long neck and a small head.

Rapid runners

Ostriches are the fastest bird runners in the world. In fact they are faster than racehorses – they can reach speeds of 75 kph (45 mph).

Ostrich

The ostrich is the only bird in the world to have only two toes.



The ostrich

Ostriches are the world's largest birds. They have feathers, which look more like fur, to keep them warm. Even though they can't fly they still have small wings, which are not used for flying, but may have various other uses like shading their young.



Moving in flocks

Like flying birds, ostriches and emus live in large groups, called flocks.